



Archbishop Tenison's

CHURCH OF ENGLAND HIGH SCHOOL

2nd July 2026

Dear Parents and Carers

As we approach the end of the school year, we wanted to communicate with you directly and bring you an update about the recruitment of a new Headteacher to succeed Mr Richard Parrish on his retirement at the end of August.

After two national advertisements, several tours of the school and a good level of interest in the opportunity to become Headteacher of Archbishop Tenison's, we received a good number of applications, held one round of interviews in March and then set up a second round in May. As we have not yet found the person we are looking for, we have now decided to advertise again after the summer. It is so important to all of us as Governors to appoint the right Headteacher for this school.

In the meantime, from 1st September 2026 we are pleased to announce that Miss Akanho and Mr Koramoa, our two Deputy Headteachers, have kindly agreed to become Joint Interim Headteachers of the school until a new headteacher can be appointed. In this they will be ably supported by Mrs Gravett and Mr Winter, currently Senior Assistant Headteachers, who will both become Interim Deputy Headteachers. Other senior teaching staff have also agreed to take on additional responsibilities to make this work. Full details of what has been arranged will be shared with you before the end of term.

Whilst we could have brought in an Interim Headteacher from outside the school to fill this gap in the short term, we quickly worked out it would be much better for the school to be ably led by the team of Senior Leaders currently in post, who know the school, its pupils and staff well. Following the recent OFSTED and SIAMS inspections the school has drawn up an Action Plan which these leaders are best placed to implement. As we enter the 2026-27 school year the school is in good shape and on a promising upward trajectory.

From September the focus will be on ensuring that the new school year starts well and that the good work on the behaviour and culture, teaching and learning, assessment and progress, and on improving the school's facilities and building up the Sixth Form in size can all continue.

We have appointed most of the new teachers we need. A new Science Laboratory is to be created over the summer. The Caretaker's Bungalow is being changed into a Pupil Support Centre, as part of Vision 312. The foyer in Reception is to be refurbished.

We look forward to writing to you again before the end of term.

Yours sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Richard Parrish". The signature is written in a cursive style with a large 'R' and a stylized 'P'.

Richard Parrish
Headteacher